

SOC Analyst Career Chat Summary

User Career Focus

User is preparing for entry-level cybersecurity jobs, especially SOC Analyst roles. They prefer remote roles but are open to hybrid or on-site positions near Stamford, CT. They are also open to internships, contract, and part-time work while completing a course through October 2025.

SOC Analyst Role - Simple Description

A SOC Analyst is like a security guard for computer systems—they watch over a company's digital environment to catch signs of hacking or suspicious activity. They investigate alerts, figure out if something dangerous is happening, and take steps to stop or report it. This role exists to protect sensitive information and keep businesses safe from cyberattacks, just like locks and alarms protect a building from burglars.

Top Cybersecurity Incidents to Know

- SolarWinds (2020)
- Colonial Pipeline (2021)
- Microsoft Exchange / Hafnium (2021)
- MOVEit (2023)
- Capital One (2019)
- MGM Resorts (2023)
- JBS Foods (2021)

These are valuable to reference during interviews.

Key Security Concepts Explained

- Zero-day: A vulnerability with no known fix or patch.
- MFA Fatigue: Attackers trick users by sending repeated login prompts.
- Supply Chain Attack: Harming a target through a third-party vendor.
- Ransomware / Double Extortion: Data is locked and threats are made to leak it.
- Lateral Movement: Attackers spreading within a network after breaking in.
- Cloud Misconfiguration: Mistakes in cloud settings that expose data.

Best Cybersecurity Jobs for Asperger's Syndrome (Ranked)

1. Security Automation Engineer
2. Digital Forensics Analyst
3. Threat Intelligence Researcher
4. SOC Analyst
5. Compliance / GRC Analyst
6. Vulnerability Researcher / Exploit Developer

SOC Analyst Roadmap (90-120 Days)

1. Learn Networking & Cybersecurity Basics (TryHackMe, Professor Messer)
2. Master Tools (Splunk, Wireshark, MITRE ATT&CK)
3. Practice alert triage, write reports, and simulate interviews

4. Use platforms like IBM Cybersecurity Analyst, CyberDefenders, Blue Team Level Up

Day in the Life of a SOC Analyst

Morning: Check alerts, review logs. Midday: Triage threats, investigate suspicious activity. Afternoon: Escalate real incidents, document findings, attend team syncs. Tools used: SIEM (e.g., Splunk), EDR (e.g., CrowdStrike), log analyzers, ticketing systems.

Entry-Level Cybersecurity Jobs (June 2025)

- GitLab: Associate Support Engineer (Remote)
- Rapid7: Associate Detection & Response Analyst (Remote/Hybrid)
- SS&C: Junior SOC Analyst (Remote - NJ)
- BlackCloak: Triage Specialist (Remote - Pacific Time)
- New Light Technologies: Junior Cybersecurity Analyst (Remote)
- Lockheed Martin: Cyber Defense Analyst (On-site)
- Ryder: IT Audit Intern (Remote)
- Eide Bailly: Cybersecurity Intern (Hybrid - UT)